

Part One

RUMBLING WITH VULNERABILITY

Section Three: The Armory

Exercise 1: Armored Leadership versus Daring Leadership

Content covered on pages 76-114 of Dare to Lead.

“Courage is contagious. To scale daring leadership and build courage in teams and organizations, we have to cultivate a culture in which brave work, tough conversations, and whole hearts are the expectation, and armor is not necessary or rewarded.”

- Brené Brown

Now is a good time to revisit your permission slips and/or container building as we dig deeper into the work.

Exercise Instructions:

- 01.** For each of the 16 elements on the model on the next two pages, rate your team’s culture on the spectrum of Armored Leadership (1 point) to Daring Leadership (4 points). You can refer back to the book for fuller explanations of the concepts.
- 02.** Add up the number of points and enter that total in the top of the model. Your total will be somewhere between 16 and 64.
- 03.** Write that total on a sticky note and use the Turn & Learn process to share your total with the group.
- 04.** As a team, decide on the two most daring and the two most armored behaviors your team displays.
- 05.** Dig into the cultural norms influencing these behaviors. For example, what are the rewards for daring versus armored leadership?
- 06.** What is one shared commitment that everyone can make as a group to create a more daring leadership culture?

Exercise 1: Armored Leadership versus Daring Leadership (*continued*)

Content covered on pages 76-114 of *Dare to Lead*.

	<i>Armored Leadership</i>	<i>Total: _____</i>	<i>Daring Leadership</i>
01.	Driving Perfectionism and Fostering Fear of Failure	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Modeling and Encouraging Healthy Striving, Empathy, and Self-Compassion
02.	Working from Scarcity and Squandering Opportunities for Joy and Recognition	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Practicing Gratitude and Celebrating Milestones and Victories
03.	Numbing	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Setting Boundaries and Finding Real Comfort
04.	Propagating the False Dichotomy of Victim or Viking, Crush or Be Crushed	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Practicing Integration—Strong Back, Soft Front, Wild Heart
05.	Being a Knower and Being Right	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Being a Learner and Getting It Right
06.	Hiding Behind Cynicism	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Modeling Clarity, Kindness, and Hope
07.	Using Criticism as Self-Protection	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Making Contributions and Taking Risks
08.	Using Power Over	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Using Power With, Power To, and Power Within
09.	Hustling for Our Worth	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Knowing Our Value
10.	Leading for Compliance and Control	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Cultivating Commitment and Shared Purpose
11.	Weaponizing Fear and Uncertainty	1 2 3 4 ←————→	Acknowledging, Naming, and Normalizing Collective Fear and Uncertainty

(chart continued on next page)

Exercise 1: Armored Leadership versus Daring Leadership (*continued*)

Content covered on pages 76-114 of *Dare to Lead*.

	<i>Armored Leadership</i>		<i>Daring Leadership</i>
12.	Rewarding Exhaustion as a Status Symbol and Attaching Productivity to Self-Worth		Modeling and Supporting Rest, Play, and Recovery
13.	Tolerating Discrimination, Echo Chambers, and a “Fitting In” Culture		Cultivating a Culture of Belonging, Inclusivity, and Diverse Perspectives
14.	Collecting Gold Stars		Giving Gold Stars
15.	Zigzagging and Avoiding		Straight Talking and Taking Action
16.	Leading from Hurt		Leading from Heart